

HARRINGTON CAPITAL PLC — COMPANY BRIEF

Infrastructure Operations Team | Confidential — Internal Use Only

COMPANY OVERVIEW

Company: Harrington Capital plc **Headquarters:** 1 Threadneedle Street, London EC2R 8AY
Division: Technology & Infrastructure — Enterprise Operations **Industry:** Financial Services (Asset Management / Capital Markets) **Employees:** 2,400 across London, Edinburgh, and Dublin **AUM (Assets Under Management):** £38 billion **Regulatory status:** FCA-authorized and regulated (Firm Reference: 189445) **IT estate size:** ~1,800 managed endpoints, 340 servers (hybrid on-premises + Azure)

WHAT HARRINGTON CAPITAL DOES

Harrington Capital plc is a mid-large UK asset management and capital markets firm. It manages institutional and retail investment portfolios across fixed income, equities, and alternatives. Its Technology & Infrastructure division supports trading platforms, risk systems, client reporting, and the internal enterprise estate that underpins all of it.

The firm operates under strict FCA oversight and is subject to DORA (Digital Operational Resilience Act) compliance requirements effective January 2025, which mandate documented operational resilience testing, incident reporting within defined timeframes, and maintained ICT risk registers.

YOUR ROLE

Title: Infrastructure Engineer (Enterprise Infrastructure Operations) **Team:** Infrastructure Operations — reporting to Head of Infrastructure, James Okafor **Location:** London (hybrid —

3 days on-site at Threadneedle Street) **Start date:** Week 1 of simulation **Contract:** Permanent **Salary band:** £54,000 – £62,000

You are joining a six-person infrastructure team responsible for the hybrid estate: Azure cloud resources, on-premises Windows Server and Linux workloads, network operations, and the monitoring and automation layer that keeps everything running.

THE SITUATION — WHY YOU ARE HERE

The previous infrastructure engineer, Callum Reid, left eight weeks ago. He held significant undocumented knowledge about the estate. Since his departure:

- **Three undocumented servers** have been identified that no one can fully account for
- **Monitoring coverage is incomplete** — 11 servers have no Prometheus scrape target configured
- **The Active Directory OU structure** was reorganised by Callum but never documented
- **No IaC exists** for the Azure resources — everything was provisioned manually through the portal
- **The last DR test** was conducted 14 months ago (DORA requires annual testing with documented evidence)
- **Backup jobs are running** but no one has verified restore integrity in over a year
- **A P1 incident** occurred six weeks ago (the trading platform's primary file server ran out of disk space) — the incident was resolved but no formal RCA was ever filed with the change board

Your first 90 days have three immediate priorities assigned by James Okafor:

1. **Codify the infrastructure** — build Terraform for the Azure estate and document what exists
2. **Restore monitoring coverage** — get all hosts into Prometheus/Grafana
3. **File the overdue RCA** and establish a proper incident management process

Beyond those priorities, you will automate common operations, harden the Linux estate, stand up a proper DR test, and leave the team with a maintainable, documented infrastructure repository.

THE HARD DEADLINES

Deadline	Requirement	Owner
Week 3	Azure IaC (Terraform) for all cloud resources committed to GitHub	You
Week 4	AD DS fully documented — OU structure, GPO inventory, user count	You
Week 5	All 23 managed hosts visible in Prometheus/Grafana	You
Week 6	Overdue P1 RCA submitted to change board	You
Week 8	DR test completed with documented evidence — DORA requirement	James Okafor
Week 10	Automation suite (PowerShell + Ansible) committed and runbooks filed	You
Week 12	Full handover pack ready — infrastructure repository self-contained	You

YOUR TEAM

James Okafor — Head of Infrastructure

avatar: JO | **relationship:** manager James has been at Harrington for nine years. He is methodical, detail-oriented, and runs a tight ship. He expects written evidence of everything — "if it isn't in the repo, it didn't happen." He will be your primary contact throughout the simulation. He gives direct feedback and responds poorly to vague updates.

Priya Sharma — Senior Infrastructure Engineer

avatar: PS | **relationship:** colleague Priya has been on the team for four years and owns the networking layer — VNet configurations, NSG rules, firewall policies, and VPN. She is technically strong and will share her expertise if asked, but she is extremely busy supporting a parallel Azure migration project. She left you an incomplete set of process notes when you joined. She mentions things in passing that turn out to be critical.

Marcus Webb — Security & Compliance Lead

avatar: MW | **relationship:** stakeholder Marcus sits in the Risk & Compliance division but works closely with Infrastructure on FCA and DORA obligations. He will appear to raise compliance constraints — in particular, DORA Article 11 (ICT continuity policy) and the requirement for evidence-based resilience testing. His constraints are non-negotiable. If an RCA is not filed, Marcus will escalate to the CTO.

Sophie Cartwright — CTO

avatar: SC | **relationship:** stakeholder Sophie appears once — in Phase 8 — to receive the executive infrastructure summary. She expects concise, evidence-based briefings. She will

not read more than one page. She does not want to hear about tools or process — she wants risk status, remediation completed, and cost impact.

THE INFRASTRUCTURE ESTATE

Azure (Cloud)

Resource	Name	Region	Notes
Resource Group	rg-harrington-prod	UK South	Primary production RG
Resource Group	rg-harrington-dev	UK South	Dev/test environment
Virtual Network	vnet-harrington-prod	UK South	10.0.0.0/16
Subnet — App	snet-app	10.0.1.0/24	App tier
Subnet — Data	snet-data	10.0.2.0/24	Data tier
Subnet — Mgmt	snet-mgmt	10.0.3.0/24	Management
NSG	nsg-app	—	Blocks port 22 inbound from internet
NSG	nsg-mgmt	—	Allows RDP/SSH from management subnet only
VM	vm-harrington-dc01	UK South	Windows Server 2022 — Domain Controller
VM	vm-harrington-app01	UK South	Ubuntu 22.04 LTS — App server
VM	vm-harrington-mon01	UK South	Ubuntu 22.04 LTS — Monitoring (Prometheus/Grafana)

On-Premises (VirtualBox for simulation)

Server	OS	Role	Notes
HC-DC01	Windows Server 2022	Domain Controller, DNS	Primary DC — Callum's undocumented OU structure
HC-APP01	Ubuntu 22.04 LTS	Application workload	SSH hardening incomplete
HC-MON01	Ubuntu 22.04 LTS	Monitoring host	Prometheus + Grafana

Naming Convention

Servers: HC-[FUNCTION][NUMBER] (e.g. HC-DC01, HC-APP01, HC-MON01) **Azure resources:** [type]-harrington-[env] (e.g. vm-harrington-prod-dc01) **GitHub branches:** main (protected), feature/[phase]-[task]

REGULATORY CONTEXT

FCA (Financial Conduct Authority) Harrington is FCA-regulated. All system changes must go through a formal Change Advisory Board (CAB) process. Emergency changes are permitted but must be retrospectively documented within 24 hours.

DORA (Digital Operational Resilience Act) — Key obligations for Infrastructure: - Article 11: ICT Business Continuity Policy — must be documented and tested annually - Article 17: ICT-related incident management — P1 incidents must be classified, reported, and RCA filed - Article 26: Operational resilience testing — evidence of DR test required, stored for 5 years

ISO 27001 Harrington holds ISO 27001 certification. Server hardening baselines, access controls, and patch currency must be maintained and evidenced.

PROJECT NAMING STANDARDS

Asset	Standard	Example
GitHub repo	harrington-infrastructure-operations	github.com/[you]/harrington-infrastructure-operations
Terraform workspace	harrington-prod / harrington-dev	—
Resource Group (Azure)	rg-harrington-[env]	rg-harrington-prod
VM names (Azure)	vm-harrington-[env]-[role]	vm-harrington-prod-dc01
VM names (VirtualBox)	HC-[ROLE][NN]	HC-DC01
Incident tickets	INC-[YYYYMMDD]-[NNN]	INC-20260612-001
Change requests	CHG-[YYYYMMDD]-[NNN]	CHG-20260612-001
Runbooks	RB-[FUNCTION]-[VERSION]	RB-USER-PROVISIONING-v1

SPRINT TIMELINE

Week	Focus	Key Deliverable
Week 1 (Phase 0)	Environment setup and validation	Toolchain confirmed, GitHub repo created
Week 2 (Phase 1)	Azure IaC — Terraform	Azure resources deployed via code
Week 3 (Phase 2)	Active Directory	DC built, OU structure documented, users created
Week 4 (Phase 3)	Linux hardening	Ubuntu hardened via Ansible, SSH secured
Week 5 (Phase 4)	Containerisation	Docker Compose deployment running
Week 6 (Phase 5)	Monitoring	All hosts in Prometheus/Grafana
Week 7 (Phase 6)	Incident management	Overdue RCA filed, GLPI process established
Week 8 (Phase 7)	Automation	PowerShell suite + Ansible runbooks committed
Week 9 (Phase 8)	DR test	Backup verified, DR evidence filed, exec report
Week 10 (Phase 9)	Portfolio	Repo polished, Wiki complete, interview ready

GLOSSARY

Term	Meaning
AD DS	Active Directory Domain Services
CAB	Change Advisory Board — approves infrastructure changes
DORA	Digital Operational Resilience Act (EU/UK, effective Jan 2025)
DR	Disaster Recovery
FCA	Financial Conduct Authority
GPO	Group Policy Object
IaC	Infrastructure as Code
INC	Incident ticket prefix
CHG	Change request prefix
NSG	Network Security Group (Azure)
OU	Organisational Unit (Active Directory)
P1	Priority 1 — highest severity incident
RCA	Root Cause Analysis
RG	Resource Group (Azure)
RB	Runbook prefix
VNet	Virtual Network (Azure)
ufw	Uncomplicated Firewall (Ubuntu)
fail2ban	Intrusion prevention software for Linux
AUM	Assets Under Management